

The Frankfurt School



Key members of the Frankfurt School including Horkheimer and Adorno (front left and right).

Almost 70 years after the *Communist Manifesto*, Marx's ideas of a socialist state were made real by the formation of the Soviet Union. Marxist political philosophy was gaining followers worldwide and other countries were soon to follow suit. But some Marxist philosophers, especially in Europe, felt that communism was beginning to lose sight of the core values of Marxism and were as critical of apologists for the Soviet regime under Stalin as they were of capitalism.

A group of thinkers, initially based at the Institute for Social Research at the University of Frankfurt, formed to establish a new form of Marxism bringing in ideas from sociology, psychology and existentialist philosophy. Leading figures of the so-called Frankfurt School (a term of convenience for a group that were only loosely connected) included philosophers Max Horkheimer, Walter Benjamin, Herbert Marcuse, and Theodor Adorno; among the next generation who further developed these ideas were Jürgen Habermas and György Lukács.